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Routing provider queues

Abstract

Disclosed are systems, methods, and non-transitory computer-readable media for routing provider queues. A method includes receiving a plurality of feedback data each associated with one of a plurality of routing providers, each of the plurality of feedback data indicating whether messages allocated to a corresponding routing provider were successfully delivered, determining a conversion rate for each routing provider based on corresponding feedback data, determining a congestion level for each routing provider based on a rate at which messages are dequeued from a message queue of a corresponding routing provider, and determining a performance level of each routing provider based on the corresponding conversion rate and the corresponding congestion level.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of co-pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/558,572, filed Dec. 21, 2021, which claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/135,367, filed on Jan. 8, 2021, each of which is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) An embodiment of the present subject matter relates generally to message routing and, more specifically, to routing provider queues.

BACKGROUND

(2) Messaging systems sometimes utilize multiple routing providers to deliver messages. For example, messaging systems may select from the routing providers based on price and/or performance. Current systems utilize a single queue to handle message allocation to the various routing providers. Messages in the queue are allocated to the appropriate routing provider in the order in which they were added to the queue. The routing provider that receives the allocated message may either accept or reject the message based on their current throughput. Messages that

are rejected are added back to the queue, resulting in unwanted delay and unnecessary resource usage. Accordingly, improvements are needed.

SUMMARY

(3) A message routing system uses individual routing provider queues assigned to each routing provider to allocate messages to the routing providers. To alleviate the issue of unwanted delay associated with previous systems that use a single queue to allocate messages to multiple routing providers, the message routing system allocates messages to each routing provider from a routing provider queue designated to the specific routing provider. To further improve performance, the message routing system allocates the messages to each routing provider in response to receiving requests from the routing provider indicating that throughput is available. This ensures that the routing provider has adequate capacity to handle each allocated message and no additional delay is introduced.

(4) Use of the routing provider queues further allows for the congestion of each routing provider to be monitored by the message routing system. Current systems generally gauge performance of a routing provider based on whether messages transmitted by the routing provider were successfully delivered. While this does provide insight into whether a message is likely to be successfully delivered, it does not provide any insight into congestion associated with the routing provider that may cause a delay in the message being delivered. The message routing system monitors the speed or rate at which messages from each routing provider queue are allocated to the routing providers to estimate the congestion level being experienced by each routing provider. The message routing system may use this estimated congestion level as an input when selecting a routing provider to deliver a message.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) In the drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, like numerals may describe similar components in different views. Like numerals having different letter suffixes may represent different instances of similar components. Some embodiments are illustrated by way of example, and not limitation, in the figures of the accompanying drawings in which:

(2) FIG. 1 shows a system for allocating messages using routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a message routing system, according to some example embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 shows communications within a system for allocating messages using routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of a method for allocate messages to routing providers using designated routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments.

(6) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram of a method for determined a performance level of a routing provider, according to some example embodiments.

(7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating components of a machine, according to some example embodiments, able to read instructions from a machine-readable medium (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium) and perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(8) FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating components of a machine, according to some example embodiments, able to read instructions from a machine-readable medium (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium) and perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) In the following description, for purposes of explanation, various details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of some example embodiments. It will be apparent, however, to

one skilled in the art, that the present subject matter may be practiced without these specific details, or with slight alterations.

(10) Reference in the specification to “one embodiment” or “an embodiment” means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment is included in at least one embodiment of the present subject matter. Thus, the appearances of the phrase “in one embodiment” or “in an embodiment” appearing in various places throughout the specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment.

(11) For purposes of explanation, specific configurations and details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present subject matter. However, it will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that embodiments of the subject matter described may be practiced without the specific details presented herein, or in various combinations, as described herein. Furthermore, well-known features may be omitted or simplified in order not to obscure the described embodiments. Various examples may be given throughout this description. These are merely descriptions of specific embodiments. The scope or meaning of the claims is not limited to the examples given.

(12) Disclosed are systems, methods, and non-transitory computer-readable media for routing provider queues. A message routing system uses individual routing provider queues assigned to each routing provider to allocate messages to the routing providers. For example, the message routing system allocates messages to each routing provider from a routing provider queue designated to the specific routing provider. Routing providers request that messages be allocated from their designated routing provider queue based on capacity, thereby ensuring that the routing provider has adequate capacity to handle each allocated message. Use of the routing provider queues further allows for the congestion of each routing provider to be monitored by the message routing system, which may be used by the message routing system as an input when selecting a routing provider to deliver a message.

(13) FIG. 1 shows a system **100** for allocating messages using routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments. As shown, multiple devices (i.e., client device **102**, client device **104**, customer computing system **106**, routing providers **108** and message routing system **110**) are connected to a communication network **112** and configured to communicate with each other through use of the communication network **112**. The communication network **112** is any type of network, including a local area network (LAN), such as an intranet, a wide area network (WAN), such as the internet, a telephone and mobile device network, such as cellular network, or any combination thereof. Further, the communication network **112** may be a public network, a private network, or a combination thereof. The communication network **112** is implemented using any number of communication links associated with one or more service providers, including one or more wired communication links, one or more wireless communication links, or any combination thereof. Additionally, the communication network **112** is configured to support the transmission of data formatted using any number of protocols.

(14) Multiple computing devices can be connected to the communication network **112**. A computing device is any type of general computing device capable of network communication with other computing devices. For example, a computing device can be a personal computing device such as a desktop or workstation, a business server, or a portable computing device, such as a laptop, smart phone, or a tablet personal computer (PC). A computing device can include some or all of the features, components, and peripherals of the machine **700** shown in FIG. 7.

(15) To facilitate communication with other computing devices, a computing device includes a communication interface configured to receive a communication, such as a request, data, and the like, from another computing device in network communication with the computing device and pass the communication along to an appropriate module running on the computing device. The communication interface also sends a communication to another computing device in network communication with the computing device.

(16) The customer computing system **106** is one or more computing devices associated with a customer of the message routing system **110**. A customer may be a person, business, company, and/or any other type of entity that uses the services provided by message routing system **110** to transmit communication messages to intended recipients. A communication message may be any of a variety of types of messages that are transmitted to a receiving client device **102** with the purpose of being presented to a user of the client device **102**, such as by being displayed on a display of the client device **102**. For example, a communication message may be a text-based message, such as a Short Message Service (SMS) message, a multimedia-based message, such as a Multimedia Messaging Service (MMS) message, and the like.

(17) The customer may use the functionality of the message routing system **110** as part of a service provided by the customer. The customer may provide any type of service, such as a banking service, travel service, retail service, and the like. The service may be an online and/or offline service. That is, the service may be available only online, such as an online retailer, offline, such as a physical retailer, or both online and offline, such as a retailer that provides a website or application as well as a physical retail store.

(18) The customer computing system **106** may facilitate any service of a customer that is provided online, such as a ride-sharing service, reservation service, retail service, news service, and the like. In these types of embodiments, users may interact with the customer computing system **106** to utilize the online service provided by the customer. Users communicate with and utilize the functionality of the customer computing system **106** by using the client devices **102** and **104** that are connected to the communication network **112** by direct and/or indirect communication. The customer computing system **106**, however, does not have to provide an online service that is accessible to users. That is, the customer computing system **106** may simply be a computing system used by a customer to perform any type of functionality.

(19) Although the shown system **100** includes only two client devices **102**, **104** and one customer computing system **106**, this is only for ease of explanation and is not meant to be limiting. One skilled in the art would appreciate that the system **100** can include any number of client devices **102**, **104** and/or customer computing systems **106**. Further, each customer computing system **106** may concurrently accept communications from and initiate communication messages and/or interact with any number of client devices **102**, **104**, and support connections from a variety of different types of client devices **102**, **104**, such as desktop computers; mobile computers; mobile communications devices, e.g., mobile phones, smart phones, tablets; smart televisions; set-top boxes; and/or any other network enabled computing devices. Hence, the client devices **102** and **104** may be of varying type, capabilities, operating systems, and so forth.

(20) A user interacts with a customer computing system **106** via a client-side application installed on the client devices **102** and **104**. In some embodiments, the client-side application includes a component specific to the customer computing system **106**. For example, the component may be a stand-alone application, one or more application plug-ins, and/or a browser extension. However, the users may also interact with the customer computing system **106** via a third-party application, such as a web browser or messaging application, that resides on the client devices **102** and **104** and is configured to communicate with the customer computing system **106**. In either case, the client-side application presents a user interface (UI) for the user to interact with the customer computing system **106**. For example, the user interacts with the customer computing system **106** via a client-side application integrated with the file system or via a webpage displayed using a web browser application.

(21) A customer may use a customer computing system **106** to cause transmission of communication messages (e.g., SMS messages) to intended recipients. For example, a customer computing system **106** may provide online functionality that enables users of the customer computing system **106** to transmit messages to agents of the customer and/or other users. As another example, the customer computing system **106** may transmits messages to users to provide

the users with two-factor authentication, password resets, updates, links to content, promotions, etc.

(22) Routing providers **108** provide message delivery functionality. For example, each routing provider **108** maintains communication routes that may be used to transmit messages to their intended recipient client devices **102**, **104**. A routing provider **108** may charge a customer a fee for each message of the customer that is delivered by the routing provider **108**.

(23) The system **100** may include any number of routing providers **108**, each of which may provide varying levels of performance. For example, the likelihood that a message will be successfully delivered may vary among the routing providers **108** as well as the individual routes provided by the routing providers **108**. Further, the performance of each routing provider **108** may vary over time. Accordingly, the likelihood that a message will be delivered successfully varies based on the routing provider **108** and/or route selected to deliver the message. As such, varying selection of the routing provider **108** based on performance may provide a higher overall likelihood that messages are successfully delivered.

(24) The message routing system **110** provides functionality to optimize message routing performance for customers. For example, the message routing system **110** monitors performance of multiple routing providers **108** and allocates messages to the routing providers **108** to optimize message routing performance, such as by allocating messages to routing providers **108** that provide a high level of performance and/or low cost for delivery.

(25) The message routing system **110** maintains a separate routing provider queue for each routing provider **108**. Each routing provider queue is a queue that is designated to a specified routing provider **108** for use in allocating messages to the routing provider **108**. For example, to allocate a message to a routing provider **108**, the message routing system **110** adds the messages to the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108**. Messages added to a routing provider queue are allocated to the routing provider **108** for delivery in a predefined order (e.g., a first-in-first-out (FIFO) order).

(26) The message routing system **110** causes messages to be dequeued from message queues to respective routing providers **108**. In some implementations, the message routing system **110** allocates messages to the routing providers **108** in response to receiving requests from the routing providers **108**. For example, a routing provider **108** may transmit a request to the message routing system **110** to allocate a message to the routing provider **108** based on a current available bandwidth of the routing provider **108**. This ensures that the routing provider **108** has available bandwidth to process a new message.

(27) In response to receiving the request, the message routing system **110** allocates a message to the routing provider **108** from the routing provider queue that is designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the message routing system **110** dequeues the message from the routing provider queue and provides the message to the routing provider **108**. Each message stored in the routing provider queue may include various data used to transmit the message to its intended recipient. For example, the message may include data identifying the sender, the recipient device, the body of the messages, media included in the message, and the like.

(28) The message routing system **110** may further monitor performance of the routing provider queues to determine an estimated congestion level of each routing provider **108**. For example, the message routing system **110** may monitor the rate at which requests are received from the routing providers **108** and/or the rate at which messages are allocated to the routing providers **108** from the routing provider queues to determine the estimated congestion level for each routing provider **108**. Receiving requests from a routing provider **108** at a decreased rate may indicate an increase in congestion by the routing provider **108**. As a result, messages allocated to the routing provider **108** for delivery may take a longer period of time to be delivered.

(29) The message routing system **110** uses the estimated congestion level of each routing provider **108** as an input when selecting a routing provider **108** to deliver a message. The estimated congestion levels of the routing providers **108** may be considered along with other factors, such as

the percentage of messages that are successfully delivered by the routing providers **108**, the fee charged by each routing provider **108** to deliver a message, and the like.

(30) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a message routing system **110**, according to some example embodiments. To avoid obscuring the inventive subject matter with unnecessary detail, various functional components (e.g., modules) that are not germane to conveying an understanding of the inventive subject matter have been omitted from FIG. 2. However, a skilled artisan will readily recognize that various additional functional components may be supported by the message routing system **110** to facilitate additional functionality that is not specifically described herein.

Furthermore, the various functional modules depicted in FIG. 2 may reside on a single computing device or may be distributed across several computing devices in various arrangements such as those used in cloud-based architectures.

(31) As shown, the message routing system **110** includes a request intake component **202**, a routing provider selection component **204**, a message queueing component **206**, a dequeue request processing component **208**, a performance determination component **210**, and a data storage **212**.

(32) The request intake component **202** receives requests to deliver a message for a customer. For example, the request intake component **202** may receive the request from a customer computing system **106**. The request may be transmitted as a result of a user utilizing the online functionality provided by the customer computing system **106**. For example, a user may use a client device **102** to communicate with and utilize the functionality of the customer computing system **106**, which may involve transmission of the message. For example, a user may request to login to an account, resulting in transmission of a message to provide two-factor authentication. As another example, a user may initiate transmitting a message to an agent of the customer or another user. Alternatively, the request may be transmitted by the customer computing system **106** to provide functionality that is not in direct response to a user use of an online service. For example, the request may be transmitted by the customer computing system **106** to provide promotional materials or updates to users.

(33) The request may include data identifying the customer, data identifying the intended recipient, and/or a payload of the message. For example, the request may include a unique identifier assigned to the customer and/or the customer's account with the message routing system **110**. The request may also include an identifier for the recipient of the message, such as a phone number associated with a recipient client device **102**, an account of the message routing system **110** associated with the recipient, etc. The payload may include any of a variety of types of data, including text, images, rich media format of data and/or any combination of data formats but not limited to the above formats to be included in the message provided to the recipient.

(34) The routing provider selection component **204** selects a routing provider **108** to deliver each message. The routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider based on various factors, such as the cost to deliver messages with each routing provider **108**, a determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, customer criteria, and the like. The determined performance level of each routing provider indicates a level at which each routing provider **108** is performing based on one or more metrics, such as how likely the routing provider **108** is to successfully deliver a message to its intended recipient, a congestion level of the routing provider **108**, and the like. The customer criteria indicate preferences of the customer that is requesting to transmit the message. For example, the customer criteria may define a maximum price the customer is willing to pay to transmit messages, a minimum performance level for delivering the message, and the like.

(35) The routing provider selection component **204** may gather the cost to deliver messages with each routing provider **108**, the determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, and/or the customer criteria from the data storage **212**. The routing provider selection component **204** may then use the gathered data to select a routing provider **108** to deliver the message. For example, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that charges a cost that

is below the maximum price that the customer is willing to pay and a provides a performance level that is greater than the minimum performance level defined by the customer. In some embodiments, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that provides an optimized value based on a combination of cost and performance level.

(36) The routing provider selection component **204** provides the message queueing component **206** with data identifying the routing provider **108** that was selected to deliver the message. The message queueing component **206** adds the message to the routing provider queue designated to the selected routing provider **108**. Adding the message to the routing provider queue may include adding data used to deliver the message, such as data identifying the source and recipient of the message. The message payload or an identifier identifying the location of the message payload may also be added to the routing provider queue. The message payload may include text to be transmitted as part of the message, as well as media or other content (e.g., voice, video, audio, etc.) to be included in the message.

(37) Messages added to the routing provider queue are allocated to the routing provider **108** for delivery to their intended recipients. For example, the dequeue request processing component **208** receives dequeue requests from the routing providers **108**. A dequeue request indicates that the routing provider **108** from which the dequeue request was received is ready to receive and process a new message. For example, a routing provider **108** may transmit a dequeue request when the available bandwidth of the routing provider **108** is greater than a threshold bandwidth. The dequeue request may include data identifying the routing provider **108** and/or the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request may include a unique identifier associated with the routing provider **108** and/or the routing provider queue.

(38) In response to receiving a dequeue request, the dequeue request processing component **208** allocates a message to the routing provider **108** from the routing queue designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request processing component **208** uses the identifier included in the dequeue request to identify the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108** and then dequeues a message from the routing provider queue. Messages are dequeued from the routing provider queue in the order in which they were added to the routing provider queue. The dequeue request processing component **208** then provides the dequeued message to the routing provider **108** for delivery to its intended recipient.

(39) The performance determination component **210** determines the performance levels of the routing providers **108** based on various data. For example, the performance determination component **210** may determine the performance levels based on feedback data indicating whether messages transmitted by the routing providers **108** were successfully delivered as well as data describing performance of the routing provider queues designated to the routing providers.

(40) The performance determination component **210** may receive feedback data from the routing providers **108** and/or customer computing systems **106** indicating whether the messages allocated to the routing providers **108** were successfully delivered to their intended recipient devices (e.g., successfully received by the intended recipient devices). The performance determination component **210** may use the received feedback data to calculate a conversion rate for each routing provider **108**. The conversion rate may indicate the percentage of messages allocated to a routing provider **108** that were successful delivered. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the conversion rate for a routing provider **108** based on all of the feedback data associated with the routing provider **108** or a subset of the feedback data. For example, the performance determination component **210** may calculate the conversion rate using a sliding window of the feedback data, such as the feedback data received within a previous two-hour window. Using a sliding window of the feedback data to calculate the conversion rate results in a conversion rate that better represents a routing provider's **108** current performance.

(41) In addition to calculating a conversion rate for each routing provider **108**, the performance determination component **210** may also determine a current congestion level of each routing

provider **108**. The current congestion level for each routing provider **108** indicates a current throughput or available bandwidth of the routing provider **108**. For example, a high congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a low throughput or available bandwidth that may result in an increase in latency related to delivering messages. Alternatively, a low congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a high throughput or available bandwidth such that messages allocated to the routing provider **108** are delivered quickly or with minimal latency.

(42) The performance determination component **210** determines the congestion level of each routing provider **108** by monitoring the routing provider queue designated to each routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may monitor the rate at which messages are dequeued from each routing provider queue and/or the rate at which dequeue requests are received for each routing provider queue. The performance determination component **210** uses this rate to determine the current congestion level of the corresponding routing provider **108**. For example, a decreased or lower rate at which messages are dequeued from the routing provider queue may indicate that the routing provider **108** is experiencing an increase in congestion. As another example, an increase or higher rate at which messages are dequeued from the routing provider queue may indicate that the routing provider **108** is experiencing a decreasing and/or low level of congestion.

(43) As the congestion level of each routing provider **108** may change quickly due to various factors, the performance determination component **210** may use recent data to determine a current congestion level of each routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may determine the congestion level of each routing provider **108** based on sliding window of data, such as data gathered within a previous ten minutes. Using a sliding window provides an accurate reflection of the current congestion level being experienced by each routing providers **108**, which increases the performance of the message routing system **110** when allocating messages to a routing provider **108**.

(44) The performance determination component **210** determines the performance level of each routing provider **108** based on a combination of the conversion rate and the congestion rate of the routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may calculate a score indicating the performance level of each provider **108** based on the conversion rate and the congestion rate of the routing provider **108**. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the performance level using any of a variety of algorithms. For example, the performance determination component **210** may use the current congestion level of a routing provider **108** as a weight value applied to the conversion rate of the routing provider **108**. This is just one example and is not meant to be limiting. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the performance level in any of a variety of ways.

(45) The performance determination component **210** may store the performance level of each routing provider **108** in the data storage **212**. The stored performance levels may be accessed from the data storage **212** by other components of the message routing system **110**. For example, the routing provider selection component **204** may access the performance levels of the routing providers **108** from the data storage **212** when allocating messages to the routing providers **108**.

(46) FIG. 3 shows communications within a system **300** for allocating messages using routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments. To avoid obscuring the inventive subject matter with unnecessary detail, various functional components (e.g., modules, devices, databases, etc.) that are not germane to conveying an understanding of the inventive subject matter have been omitted from FIG. 3. However, a skilled artisan will readily recognize that various additional functional components may be supported by the system **300** to facilitate additional functionality that is not specifically described herein. Furthermore, the various functional components depicted in FIG. 3 may reside on a single computing device or may be distributed across several computing devices in various arrangements such as those used in cloud-based architectures.

(47) As shown, a user **302** uses a client-side application **304** installed on a client device **102** to utilize the functionality of a customer computing system **106**. The customer may provide any type of service, such as a banking service, travel service, retail service, and the like. The service may be an online and/or offline service. That is, the service may be available only online, such as an online retailer, offline, such as a physical retailer, or both online and offline, such as a retailer that provides a website or application as well as a physical retail store.

(48) The customer computing system **106** may transmit messages as part of its provided services. For example, the customer computing system **106** may allow the user **302** to transmit messages to an agent of the customer, transmit messages to other users **302**, request a message be transmitted to the client device **102** to provide information, password reset, etc. The customer computing system **106** may also transmit messages that are not in response to a request made by a user **302**. For example, the customer computing system **106** may transmit messages to provide a user **302** with a notification, marketing materials, etc.

(49) The customer may use the functionality of the message routing system **110** that provides optimized message routing performance. The message routing system **110** provides optimized message routing performance by allocating messages to routing providers **108** based on a determined performance level of the routing providers **108** as well as a cost charged by each routing provider **108** and/or customer criteria provided by the customer. For example, the message routing system **110** allocates messages to the routing providers **108** based performance levels determined based on a conversation rate and current congestion level of each routing provider **108**.

(50) To utilize the functionality of the message routing system **110**, the customer computing system **106** transmits a request to the message routing system **110** to transmit a message to an intended recipient. The request may include data identifying the recipient of the message. For example, the request may include a phone number or other contact identifier associated with the recipient.

(51) The request is received by the request intake component **202** of the message routing system **110**. The request intake component **202** provides the received request to the routing provider selection component **204**.

(52) The routing provider selection component **204** selects a routing provider **108** to deliver the message based on various factors, such as the cost to deliver messages with each routing provider **108**, a determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, customer criteria, and the like. The determined performance level of each routing provider indicates a level at which each routing provider **108** is performing based on one or more metrics, such as a conversion rate of the routing provider **108**, a congestion level of the routing provider **108**, and the like. The customer criteria indicate preferences of the customer that is requesting to transmit the message. For example, the customer criteria may define a maximum price the customer is willing to pay to transmit messages, a minimum performance level for delivering the message, and the like.

(53) The routing provider selection component **204** may gather the cost to deliver messages with each routing provider **108**, the determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, and/or the customer criteria from the data storage **212**. The routing provider selection component **204** may then use the gathered data to select a routing provider **108** to deliver the message. For example, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that charges a cost that is below the maximum price that the customer is willing to pay and a provides a performance level that is greater than the minimum performance level defined by the customer. In some embodiments, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that provides an optimized value based on a combination of cost and performance level.

(54) The routing provider selection component **204** provides the message queueing component **206** with data identifying the routing provider **108** that was selected to deliver the message. The message queueing component **206** adds the message to the routing provider queue **306** designated to the selected routing provider **108**. Adding the message to the routing provider queue **306** may include adding data used to deliver the message, such as data identifying the source and recipient of

the message. The message payload or an identifier identifying the location of the message payload may also be added to the routing provider queue **306**. The message payload may include text to be transmitted as part of the message, as well as media or other content (e.g., voice, video, audio, etc.) to be included in the message.

(55) Messages are allocated to a routing provider **108** from the routing provider queue **306** designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request processing component **208** receives dequeue requests from the routing providers **108**. A dequeue request indicates that the routing provider **108** from which the dequeue request was received is ready to receive and process a new message. For example, a routing provider **108** may transmit a dequeue request when an available bandwidth level of the routing provider **108** is greater than a threshold bandwidth. The dequeue request may include data identifying the routing provider **108** and/or the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request may include a unique identifier associated with the routing provider **108** and/or the routing provider queue **306**.

(56) In response to receiving a dequeue request, the dequeue request processing component **208** allocates a message to the routing provider **108** from the routing provider queue **306** designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request processing component **208** uses the identifier included in the dequeue request to identify the routing provider queue **306** designated to the routing provider **108** and then dequeues a message from the routing provider queue **306**.

Messages are dequeued from each routing provider queue **306** in the order in which they were added to the routing provider queue **306**. The dequeue request processing component **208** then provides the dequeued message to the routing provider **108** for delivery to its intended recipient.

(57) The performance determination component **210** determines the performance levels of the routing providers **108** based on various data. For example, the performance determination component **210** may determine the performance levels based on feedback data indicating whether messages transmitted by the routing providers **108** were successfully delivered as well as data describing performance of the routing provider queues **306** designated to the routing providers **108**.

(58) As shown, the performance determination component **210** may receive feedback data from the routing providers **108** and/or customer computing systems **106** indicating whether the messages allocated to the routing providers **108** were successfully delivered to their intended recipient devices (e.g., successfully received by the intended recipient devices). The performance determination component **210** may use the received feedback data to calculate a conversion rate for each routing provider **108**. The conversion rate may indicate the percentage of messages allocated to a routing provider **108** that were successfully delivered.

(59) In addition to calculating a conversion rate for each routing provider **108**, the performance determination component **210** may also determine a current congestion level of each routing provider **108**. The current congestion level for each routing provider **108** indicates a current throughput or available bandwidth of the routing provider **108**. For example, a high congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a low throughput or available bandwidth that may result in an increase in latency related to delivering messages. Alternatively, a low congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a high throughput or available bandwidth such that messages allocated to the routing provider **108** are delivered quickly or with minimal latency.

(60) The performance determination component **210** determines the congestion level of each routing provider **108** by monitoring the routing provider queue **306** designated to each routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may monitor the rate at which messages are dequeued from each routing provider queue and/or the rate at which dequeue requests are received for each routing provider queue. The performance determination component **210** uses this rate to determine the current congestion level of the corresponding routing provider **108**.

(61) The performance determination component **210** determines the performance level of each routing provider **108** based on a combination of the conversion rate and the congestion rate of the

routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may calculate a score indicating the performance level of each provider **108** based on the conversion rate and the congestion rate of the routing provider **108**.

(62) As shown, the performance determination component **210** may store the performance level of each routing provider **108** in the data storage **212**. The stored performance levels may be accessed from the data storage **212** by other components of the message routing system **110**. For example, the routing provider selection component **204** may access the performance levels of the routing providers **108** from the data storage **212** when allocating messages to the routing providers **108**.

(63) FIG. **4** is a flow diagram of a method **400** to allocate messages to routing providers **108** using designated routing provider queues, according to some example embodiments. The method **400** may be embodied in computer readable instructions for execution by one or more computer processors such that the operations of the method **400** may be performed in part or in whole by the message routing system **110**; accordingly, the method **400** is described below by way of example with reference to the message routing system **110**. However, it shall be appreciated that at least some of the operations of the method **400** may be deployed on various other hardware and/or software configurations and the method **400** is not intended to be limited to the message routing system **110**.

(64) At operation **402**, the request intake component **202** receives a request to transmit a message to a destination device. The request intake component **202** receives requests to deliver a message for a customer. For example, the request intake component **202** may receive the request from a customer computing system **106**. The request may be transmitted as a result of a user utilizing the online functionality provided by the customer computing system **106**. For example, a user may use a client device **102** to communicate with and utilize the functionality of the customer computing system **106**, which may involve transmission of the message. For example, a user may request to login to an account, resulting in transmission of a message to provide two-factor authentication. As another example, a user may initiate transmitting a message to an agent of the customer or another user. Alternatively, the request may be transmitted by the customer computing system **106** to provide functionality that is not in direct response to a user use of an online service. For example, the request may be transmitted by the customer computing system **106** to provide promotional materials or updates to users.

(65) The request may include data identifying the customer, data identifying the intended recipient, and/or a payload of the message. For example, the request may include a unique identifier assigned to the customer and/or the customer's account with the message routing system **110**. The request may also include an identifier for the recipient of the message, such as a phone number associated with a recipient client device **102**, an account of the message routing system **110** associated with the recipient, etc. The payload may include any of a variety of types of data, including text, images, rich media format of data and/or any combination of data formats but not limited to the above formats to be included in the message provided to the recipient.

(66) At operation **404**, the routing provider selection component **204** selects a routing provider from a plurality of routing providers to transmit the message to the destination device. The routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider based on various factors, such as the cost to deliver messages with each routing provider **108**, a determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, customer criteria, and the like. The determined performance level of each routing provider indicates a level at which each routing provider **108** is performing based on one or more metrics, such as how likely the routing provider **108** is to successfully deliver a message to its intended recipient, a congestion level of the routing provider **108**, and the like. The customer criteria indicate preferences of the customer that is requesting to transmit the message. For example, the customer criteria may define a maximum price the customer is willing to pay to transmit messages, a minimum performance level for delivering the message, and the like.

(67) The routing provider selection component **204** may gather the cost to deliver messages with

each routing provider **108**, the determined performance level of each routing provider **108**, and/or the customer criteria from the data storage **212**. The routing provider selection component **204** may then use the gathered data to select a routing provider **108** to deliver the message. For example, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that charges a cost that is below the maximum price that the customer is willing to pay and a provides a performance level that is greater than the minimum performance level defined by the customer. In some embodiments, the routing provider selection component **204** may select a routing provider **108** that provides an optimized value based on a combination of cost and performance level.

(68) The routing provider selection component **204** provides the message queueing component **206** with data identifying the routing provider **108** that was selected to deliver the message. At operation **406**, the message queueing component **206** adds the message to a message queue designated to the selected routing provider. Adding the message to the routing provider queue may include adding data used to deliver the message, such as data identifying the source and recipient of the message. The message payload or an identifier identifying the location of the message payload may also be added to the routing provider queue. The message payload may include text to be transmitted as part of the message, as well as media or other content (e.g., voice, video, audio, etc.) to be included in the message. Messages added to the routing provider queue are allocated to the routing provider **108** for delivery to their intended recipients.

(69) At operation **408**, the dequeue request processing component **208** receives a dequeue request from the selected routing provider. A dequeue request indicates that the routing provider **108** from which the dequeue request was received is ready to receive and process a new message. For example, a routing provider **108** may transmit a dequeue request when the available bandwidth of the routing provider **108** is greater than a threshold bandwidth. The dequeue request may include data identifying the routing provider **108** and or the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request may include a unique identifier associated with the routing provider **108** and/or the routing provider queue.

(70) At operation **410**, the dequeue request processing component **208** dequeues the message from the message queue designated to the selected routing provider. In response to receiving a dequeue request, the dequeue request processing component **208** allocates a message to the routing provider **108** from the routing queue designated to the routing provider **108**. For example, the dequeue request processing component **208** uses the identifier included in the dequeue request to identify the routing provider queue designated to the routing provider **108** and then dequeues a message from the routing provider queue. Messages are dequeue from the routing provider queue in the order in which they were added to the routing provider queue.

(71) At operation **412**, the dequeue request processing component **208** provides the dequeued message to the selected routing provider to be transmitted to the destination device.

(72) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram of a method **500** to determine a performance level of a routing provider **108**, according to some example embodiments. The method **500** may be embodied in computer readable instructions for execution by one or more computer processors such that the operations of the method **500** may be performed in part or in whole by the message routing system **110**; accordingly, the method **500** is described below by way of example with reference to the message routing system **110**. However, it shall be appreciated that at least some of the operations of the method **500** may be deployed on various other hardware and/or software configurations and the method **500** is not intended to be limited to the message routing system **110**.

(73) At operation **502**, the performance determination component **210** receives feedback data indicating whether messages allocated to a routing provider **108** were successfully delivered. The performance determination component **210** may receive feedback data from the routing providers **108** and/or customer computing systems **106** indicating whether the messages allocated to the routing providers **108** were successfully delivered to their intended recipient devices (e.g., successfully received by the intended recipient devices).

(74) At operation **504**, the performance determination component **210** determines a conversion rate for the routing provider **108** based on the feedback data. The conversion rate may indicate the percentage of messages allocated to a routing provider **108** that were successful delivered. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the conversion rate for a routing provider **108** based on all of the feedback data associated with the routing provider **108** or a subset of the feedback data. For example, the performance determination component **210** may calculate the conversion rate using a sliding window of the feedback data, such as the feedback data received within a previous two-hour window. Using a sliding window of the feedback data to calculate the conversion rate results in a conversion rate that better represents a routing provider's **108** current performance.

(75) At operation **506**, the performance determination component **210** determines a rate at which dequeue requests are received from the routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may monitor the rate at which messages are dequeued from each routing provider queue and/or the rate at which dequeue requests are received for each routing provider queue.

(76) At operation **508**, the performance determination component **210** determines a congestion level for the routing provider **108** based on the determined rate. The current congestion level for each routing provider **108** indicates a current throughput or available bandwidth of the routing provider **108**. For example, a high congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a low throughput or available bandwidth that may result in an increase in latency related to delivering messages. Alternatively, a low congestion level may indicate that the routing provider **108** has a high throughput or available bandwidth such that messages allocated to the routing provider **108** are delivered quickly or with minimal latency.

(77) The performance determination component **210** uses the rate at which messages are dequeued from each routing provider queue and/or the rate at which dequeue requests are received for each routing provider queue to determine the current congestion level of the corresponding routing provider **108**. For example, a decreased or lower rate at which messages are dequeued from the routing provider queue may indicate that the routing provider **108** is experiencing an increase in congestion. As another example, an increase or higher rate at which messages are dequeued from the routing provider queue may indicate that the routing provider **108** is experiencing a decreasing and/or low level of congestion.

(78) As the congestion level of each routing provider **108** may change quickly due to various factors, the performance determination component **210** may use recent data to determine a current congestion level of each routing provider **108**. For example, the performance determination component **210** may determine the congestion level of each routing provider **108** based on sliding window of data, such as data gathered within a previous ten minutes. Using a sliding window provides an accurate reflection of the current congestion level being experienced by each routing providers **108**, which increases the performance of the message routing system **110** when allocating messages to a routing provider **108**.

(79) At operation **510**, the performance determination component **210** determines a performance level of the routing provider **108** based on the conversion rate and the congestion level. For example, the performance determination component **210** may calculate a score indicating the performance level of each provider **108** based on the conversion rate and the congestion rate of the routing provider **108**. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the performance level using any of a variety of algorithms. For example, the performance determination component **210** may use the current congestion level of a routing provider **108** as a weight value applied to the conversion rate of the routing provider **108**. This is just one example and is not meant to be limiting. The performance determination component **210** may calculate the performance level in any of a variety of ways.

(80) Software Architecture

(81) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating an example software architecture **606**, which may be used in conjunction with various hardware architectures herein described. FIG. 6 is a non-limiting example of a software architecture **606** and it will be appreciated that many other architectures may be implemented to facilitate the functionality described herein. The software architecture **606** may execute on hardware such as machine **700** of FIG. 7 that includes, among other things, processors **704**, memory **714**, and (input/output) I/O components **718**. A representative hardware layer **652** is illustrated and can represent, for example, the machine **700** of FIG. 7. The representative hardware layer **652** includes a processing unit **654** having associated executable instructions **604**. Executable instructions **604** represent the executable instructions of the software architecture **606**, including implementation of the methods, components, and so forth described herein. The hardware layer **652** also includes memory and/or storage modules **656**, which also have executable instructions **604**. The hardware layer **652** may also comprise other hardware **658**.

(82) In the example architecture of FIG. 6, the software architecture **606** may be conceptualized as a stack of layers where each layer provides particular functionality. For example, the software architecture **606** may include layers such as an operating system **602**, libraries **620**, frameworks/middleware **618**, applications **616**, and a presentation layer **614**. Operationally, the applications **616** and/or other components within the layers may invoke application programming interface (API) calls **608** through the software stack and receive a response such as messages **612** in response to the API calls **608**. The layers illustrated are representative in nature and not all software architectures have all layers. For example, some mobile or special purpose operating systems may not provide a frameworks/middleware **618**, while others may provide such a layer. Other software architectures may include additional or different layers.

(83) The operating system **602** may manage hardware resources and provide common services. The operating system **602** may include, for example, a kernel **622**, services **624**, and drivers **626**. The kernel **622** may act as an abstraction layer between the hardware and the other software layers. For example, the kernel **622** may be responsible for memory management, processor management (e.g., scheduling), component management, networking, security settings, and so on. The services **624** may provide other common services for the other software layers. The drivers **626** are responsible for controlling or interfacing with the underlying hardware. For instance, the drivers **626** include display drivers, camera drivers, Bluetooth® drivers, flash memory drivers, serial communication drivers (e.g., Universal Serial Bus (USB) drivers), Wi-Fi® drivers, audio drivers, power management drivers, and so forth, depending on the hardware configuration.

(84) The libraries **620** provide a common infrastructure that is used by the applications **616** and/or other components and/or layers. The libraries **620** provide functionality that allows other software components to perform tasks in an easier fashion than to interface directly with the underlying operating system **602** functionality (e.g., kernel **622**, services **624**, and/or drivers **626**). The libraries **620** may include system libraries **644** (e.g., C standard library) that may provide functions such as memory allocation functions, string manipulation functions, mathematical functions, and the like. In addition, the libraries **620** may include API libraries **646** such as media libraries (e.g., libraries to support presentation and manipulation of various media format such as MPEG4, H.264, MP3, AAC, AMR, JPG, PNG), graphics libraries (e.g., an OpenGL framework that may be used to render 2D and 3D in a graphic content on a display), database libraries (e.g., SQLite that may provide various relational database functions), web libraries (e.g., WebKit that may provide web browsing functionality), and the like. The libraries **620** may also include a wide variety of other libraries **648** to provide many other APIs to the applications **616** and other software components/modules.

(85) The frameworks/middleware **618** (also sometimes referred to as middleware) provide a higher-level common infrastructure that may be used by the applications **616** and/or other software components/modules. For example, the frameworks/middleware **618** may provide various graphical user interface (GUI) functions, high-level resource management, high-level location services, and so forth. The frameworks/middleware **618** may provide a broad spectrum of other

APIs that may be used by the applications **616** and/or other software components/modules, some of which may be specific to a particular operating system **602** or platform.

(86) The applications **616** include built-in applications **638** and/or third-party applications **640**. Examples of representative built-in applications **638** may include, but are not limited to, a contacts application, a browser application, a book reader application, a location application, a media application, a messaging application, and/or a game application. Third-party applications **640** may include an application developed using the ANDROID™ or IOS™ software development kit (SDK) by an entity other than the vendor of the particular platform, and may be mobile software running on a mobile operating system such as IOS™, ANDROID™, WINDOWS® Phone, or other mobile operating systems. The third-party applications **640** may invoke the API calls **608** provided by the mobile operating system (such as operating system **602**) to facilitate functionality described herein.

(87) The applications **616** may use built in operating system functions (e.g., kernel **622**, services **624**, and/or drivers **626**), libraries **620**, and frameworks/middleware **618** to create UIs to interact with users of the system. Alternatively, or additionally, in some systems, interactions with a user may occur through a presentation layer, such as presentation layer **614**. In these systems, the application/component “logic” can be separated from the aspects of the application/component that interact with a user.

(88) FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating components of a machine **700**, according to some example embodiments, able to read instructions **604** from a machine-readable medium (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium) and perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein. Specifically, FIG. 7 shows a diagrammatic representation of the machine **700** in the example form of a computer system, within which instructions **710** (e.g., software, a program, an application, an applet, an app, or other executable code) for causing the machine **700** to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein may be executed. As such, the instructions **710** may be used to implement modules or components described herein. The instructions **710** transform the general, non-programmed machine **700** into a particular machine **700** programmed to carry out the described and illustrated functions in the manner described. In alternative embodiments, the machine **700** operates as a standalone device or may be coupled (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the machine **700** may operate in the capacity of a server machine or a client machine in a server-client network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment. The machine **700** may comprise, but not be limited to, a server computer, a client computer, a PC, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a netbook, a set-top box (STB), a personal digital assistant (PDA), an entertainment media system, a cellular telephone, a smart phone, a mobile device, a wearable device (e.g., a smart watch), a smart home device (e.g., a smart appliance), other smart devices, a web appliance, a network router, a network switch, a network bridge, or any machine **700** capable of executing the instructions **710**, sequentially or otherwise, that specify actions to be taken by machine **700**. Further, while only a single machine **700** is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include a collection of machines that individually or jointly execute the instructions **710** to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(89) The machine **700** may include processors **704**, memory/storage **706**, and I/O components **718**, which may be configured to communicate with each other such as via a bus **702**. The memory/storage **706** may include a memory **714**, such as a main memory, or other memory storage, and a storage unit **716**, both accessible to the processors **704** such as via the bus **702**. The storage unit **716** and memory **714** store the instructions **710** embodying any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The instructions **710** may also reside, completely or partially, within the memory **714**, within the storage unit **716**, within at least one of the processors **704** (e.g., within the processor's cache memory), or any suitable combination thereof, during execution thereof by the machine **700**. Accordingly, the memory **714**, the storage unit **716**, and the

memory of processors **704** are examples of machine-readable media.

(90) The I/O components **718** may include a wide variety of components to receive input, provide output, produce output, transmit information, exchange information, capture measurements, and so on. The specific I/O components **718** that are included in a particular machine **700** will depend on the type of machine. For example, portable machines such as mobile phones will likely include a touch input device or other such input mechanisms, while a headless server machine will likely not include such a touch input device. It will be appreciated that the I/O components **718** may include many other components that are not shown in FIG. 7. The I/O components **718** are grouped according to functionality merely for simplifying the following discussion and the grouping is in no way limiting. In various example embodiments, the I/O components **718** may include output components **726** and input components **728**. The output components **726** may include visual components (e.g., a display such as a plasma display panel (PDP), a light emitting diode (LED) display, a liquid crystal display (LCD), a projector, or a cathode ray tube (CRT)), acoustic components (e.g., speakers), haptic components (e.g., a vibratory motor, resistance mechanisms), other signal generators, and so forth. The input components **728** may include alphanumeric input components (e.g., a keyboard, a touch screen configured to receive alphanumeric input, a photo-optical keyboard, or other alphanumeric input components), point based input components (e.g., a mouse, a touchpad, a trackball, a joystick, a motion sensor, or other pointing instrument), tactile input components (e.g., a physical button, a touch screen that provides location and/or force of touches or touch gestures, or other tactile input components), audio input components (e.g., a microphone), and the like.

(91) In further example embodiments, the I/O components **718** may include biometric components **730**, motion components **734**, environmental components **736**, or position components **738** among a wide array of other components. For example, the biometric components **730** may include components to detect expressions (e.g., hand expressions, facial expressions, vocal expressions, body gestures, or eye tracking), measure biosignals (e.g., blood pressure, heart rate, body temperature, perspiration, or brain waves), identify a person (e.g., voice identification, retinal identification, facial identification, fingerprint identification, or electroencephalogram based identification), and the like. The motion components **734** may include acceleration sensor components (e.g., accelerometer), gravitation sensor components, rotation sensor components (e.g., gyroscope), and so forth. The environmental components **736** may include, for example, illumination sensor components (e.g., photometer), temperature sensor components (e.g., one or more thermometer that detect ambient temperature), humidity sensor components, pressure sensor components (e.g., barometer), acoustic sensor components (e.g., one or more microphones that detect background noise), proximity sensor components (e.g., infrared sensors that detect nearby objects), gas sensors (e.g., gas detection sensors to detect concentrations of hazardous gases for safety or to measure pollutants in the atmosphere), or other components that may provide indications, measurements, or signals corresponding to a surrounding physical environment. The position components **738** may include location sensor components (e.g., a GPS receiver component), altitude sensor components (e.g., altimeters or barometers that detect air pressure from which altitude may be derived), orientation sensor components (e.g., magnetometers), and the like.

(92) Communication may be implemented using a wide variety of technologies. The I/O components **718** may include communication components **740** operable to couple the machine **700** to a network **732** or devices **720** via coupling **724** and coupling **722**, respectively. For example, the communication components **740** may include a network interface component or other suitable device to interface with the network **732**. In further examples, communication components **740** may include wired communication components, wireless communication components, cellular communication components, near field communication (NFC) components, Bluetooth® components (e.g., Bluetooth® Low Energy), Wi-Fi® components, and other communication components to provide communication via other modalities. The devices **720** may be another

machine or any of a wide variety of peripheral devices (e.g., a peripheral device coupled via a USB).

(93) Moreover, the communication components **740** may detect identifiers or include components operable to detect identifiers. For example, the communication components **740** may include radio frequency identification (RFID) tag reader components, NFC smart tag detection components, optical reader components (e.g., an optical sensor to detect one-dimensional bar codes such as Universal Product Code (UPC) bar code, multi-dimensional bar codes such as Quick Response (QR) code, Aztec code, Data Matrix, Dataglyph, MaxiCode, PDF417, Ultra Code, UCC RSS-2D bar code, and other optical codes), or acoustic detection components (e.g., microphones to identify tagged audio signals). In addition, a variety of information may be derived via the communication components **740** such as location via Internet Protocol (IP) geo-location, location via Wi-Fi® signal triangulation, location via detecting a NFC beacon signal that may indicate a particular location, and so forth.

GLOSSARY

(94) “CARRIER SIGNAL” in this context refers to any intangible medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying instructions **710** for execution by the machine **700**, and includes digital or analog communications signals or other intangible medium to facilitate communication of such instructions **710**. Instructions **710** may be transmitted or received over the network **732** using a transmission medium via a network interface device and using any one of a number of well-known transfer protocols.

(95) “CLIENT DEVICE” in this context refers to any machine **700** that interfaces to a communications network **732** to obtain resources from one or more server systems or other client devices **102, 104**. A client device **102, 104** may be, but is not limited to, mobile phones, desktop computers, laptops, PDAs, smart phones, tablets, ultra books, netbooks, laptops, multi-processor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, game consoles, STBs, or any other communication device that a user may use to access a network **732**.

(96) “COMMUNICATIONS NETWORK” in this context refers to one or more portions of a network **732** that may be an ad hoc network, an intranet, an extranet, a virtual private network (VPN), a LAN, a wireless LAN (WLAN), a WAN, a wireless WAN (WWAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), the Internet, a portion of the Internet, a portion of the Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN), a plain old telephone service (POTS) network, a cellular telephone network, a wireless network, a Wi-Fi® network, another type of network, or a combination of two or more such networks. For example, a network **732** or a portion of a network **732** may include a wireless or cellular network and the coupling may be a Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA) connection, a Global System for Mobile communications (GSM) connection, or other type of cellular or wireless coupling. In this example, the coupling may implement any of a variety of types of data transfer technology, such as Single Carrier Radio Transmission Technology (1×RTT), Evolution-Data Optimized (EVDO) technology, General Packet Radio Service (GPRS) technology, Enhanced Data rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE) technology, third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) including 3G, fourth generation wireless (4G) networks, Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX), Long Term Evolution (LTE) standard, others defined by various standard setting organizations, other long range protocols, or other data transfer technology.

(97) “MACHINE-READABLE MEDIUM” in this context refers to a component, device or other tangible media able to store instructions **710** and data temporarily or permanently and may include, but is not be limited to, random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), buffer memory, flash memory, optical media, magnetic media, cache memory, other types of storage (e.g., erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM)), and/or any suitable combination thereof. The term “machine-readable medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple

media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, or associated caches and servers) able to store instructions **710**. The term “machine-readable medium” shall also be taken to include any medium, or combination of multiple media, that is capable of storing instructions **710** (e.g., code) for execution by a machine **700**, such that the instructions **710**, when executed by one or more processors **704** of the machine **700**, cause the machine **700** to perform any one or more of the methodologies described herein. Accordingly, a “machine-readable medium” refers to a single storage apparatus or device, as well as “cloud-based” storage systems or storage networks that include multiple storage apparatus or devices. The term “machine-readable medium” excludes signals per se.

(98) “COMPONENT” in this context refers to a device, physical entity, or logic having boundaries defined by function or subroutine calls, branch points, APIs, or other technologies that provide for the partitioning or modularization of particular processing or control functions. Components may be combined via their interfaces with other components to carry out a machine process. A component may be a packaged functional hardware unit designed for use with other components and a part of a program that usually performs a particular function of related functions. Components may constitute either software components (e.g., code embodied on a machine-readable medium) or hardware components. A “hardware component” is a tangible unit capable of performing certain operations and may be configured or arranged in a certain physical manner. In various example embodiments, one or more computer systems (e.g., a standalone computer system, a client computer system, or a server computer system) or one or more hardware components of a computer system (e.g., a processor or a group of processors **704**) may be configured by software (e.g., an application **616** or application portion) as a hardware component that operates to perform certain operations as described herein. A hardware component may also be implemented mechanically, electronically, or any suitable combination thereof. For example, a hardware component may include dedicated circuitry or logic that is permanently configured to perform certain operations. A hardware component may be a special-purpose processor, such as a field-programmable gate array (FPGA) or an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC). A hardware component may also include programmable logic or circuitry that is temporarily configured by software to perform certain operations. For example, a hardware component may include software executed by a general-purpose processor **704** or other programmable processor **704**. Once configured by such software, hardware components become specific machines **700** (or specific components of a machine **700**) uniquely tailored to perform the configured functions and are no longer general-purpose processors **704**. It will be appreciated that the decision to implement a hardware component mechanically, in dedicated and permanently configured circuitry, or in temporarily configured circuitry (e.g., configured by software), may be driven by cost and time considerations. Accordingly, the phrase “hardware component” (or “hardware-implemented component”) should be understood to encompass a tangible entity, be that an entity that is physically constructed, permanently configured (e.g., hardwired), or temporarily configured (e.g., programmed) to operate in a certain manner or to perform certain operations described herein. Considering embodiments in which hardware components are temporarily configured (e.g., programmed), each of the hardware components need not be configured or instantiated at any one instance in time. For example, where a hardware component comprises a general-purpose processor **704** configured by software to become a special-purpose processor, the general-purpose processor **704** may be configured as respectively different special-purpose processors (e.g., comprising different hardware components) at different times. Software accordingly configures a particular processor or processors **704**, for example, to constitute a particular hardware component at one instance of time and to constitute a different hardware component at a different instance of time. Hardware components can provide information to, and receive information from, other hardware components. Accordingly, the described hardware components may be regarded as being communicatively coupled. Where multiple hardware components exist contemporaneously,

communications may be achieved through signal transmission (e.g., over appropriate circuits and buses **702**) between or among two or more of the hardware components. In embodiments in which multiple hardware components are configured or instantiated at different times, communications between such hardware components may be achieved, for example, through the storage and retrieval of information in memory structures to which the multiple hardware components have access. For example, one hardware component may perform an operation and store the output of that operation in a memory device to which it is communicatively coupled. A further hardware component may then, at a later time, access the memory device to retrieve and process the stored output. Hardware components may also initiate communications with input or output devices, and can operate on a resource (e.g., a collection of information). The various operations of example methods described herein may be performed, at least partially, by one or more processors **704** that are temporarily configured (e.g., by software) or permanently configured to perform the relevant operations. Whether temporarily or permanently configured, such processors **704** may constitute processor-implemented components that operate to perform one or more operations or functions described herein. As used herein, “processor-implemented component” refers to a hardware component implemented using one or more processors **704**. Similarly, the methods described herein may be at least partially processor-implemented, with a particular processor or processors **704** being an example of hardware. For example, at least some of the operations of a method may be performed by one or more processors **704** or processor-implemented components. Moreover, the one or more processors **704** may also operate to support performance of the relevant operations in a “cloud computing” environment or as a “software as a service” (SaaS). For example, at least some of the operations may be performed by a group of computers (as examples of machines **700** including processors **704**), with these operations being accessible via a network **732** (e.g., the Internet) and via one or more appropriate interfaces (e.g., an API). The performance of certain of the operations may be distributed among the processors **704**, not only residing within a single machine **700**, but deployed across a number of machines **700**. In some example embodiments, the processors **704** or processor-implemented components may be located in a single geographic location (e.g., within a home environment, an office environment, or a server farm). In other example embodiments, the processors **704** or processor-implemented components may be distributed across a number of geographic locations.

(99) “PROCESSOR” in this context refers to any circuit or virtual circuit (a physical circuit emulated by logic executing on an actual processor **704**) that manipulates data values according to control signals (e.g., “commands,” “op codes,” “machine code,” etc.) and which produces corresponding output signals that are applied to operate a machine **700**. A processor **704** may be, for example, a central processing unit (CPU), a reduced instruction set computing (RISC) processor, a complex instruction set computing (CISC) processor, a graphics processing unit (GPU), a digital signal processor (DSP), an ASIC, a radio-frequency integrated circuit (RFIC) or any combination thereof. A processor **704** may further be a multi-core processor having two or more independent processors **704** (sometimes referred to as “cores”) that may execute instructions **710** contemporaneously.

Claims

1. A method comprising: receiving, by a processing device, a plurality of feedback data each associated with one of a plurality of routing providers, each of the plurality of feedback data indicating whether messages allocated to a corresponding routing provider were successfully delivered; determining, by the processing device, a conversion rate for each routing provider based on corresponding feedback data; determining, by the processing device, a congestion level for each routing provider based on a rate at which messages are dequeued from a message queue of a corresponding routing provider; and determining, by the processing device, a performance level of

each routing provider based on the corresponding conversion rate and the corresponding congestion level.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: selecting, based on a plurality of performance levels, a first routing provider from the plurality of routing providers to transmit a first message of a user to a client device of a recipient.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein the selecting is performed at a message routing system that is coupled to each of the plurality of routing providers via a network.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein the message routing system maintains a separate message queue of a plurality of message queues for each of the plurality of routing providers.

5. The method of claim 4, wherein the selecting is based on a subset of the plurality of performance levels calculated using a sliding window of a rate at which messages are dequeued from each message queue.

6. The method of claim 3, further comprising: adding, at the message routing system, the first message into a first message queue designated to the first routing provider.

7. The method of claim 6, further comprising: receiving, by the message routing system and from the first routing provider, a dequeue request indicating that the first routing provider has available bandwidth exceeding a predefined threshold, to process a new message; responsive to the dequeue request, determining, by the message routing system and based on a predefined order, that the first message is to be dequeued from the first message queue designated to the first routing provider; and dequeuing, by the message routing system, the first message from the first message queue to the first routing provider for delivery to the client device of the recipient.

8. A system comprising: a memory; and a computer processor, coupled to the memory, to perform operations comprising: receiving a plurality of feedback data each associated with one of a plurality of routing providers, each of the plurality of feedback data indicating whether messages allocated to a corresponding routing provider were successfully delivered; determining a conversion rate for each routing provider based on corresponding feedback data; determining a congestion level for each routing provider based on a rate at which messages are dequeued from a message queue of a corresponding routing provider; and determining a performance level of each routing provider based on the corresponding conversion rate and the corresponding congestion level.

9. The system of claim 8, the operations further comprising: selecting, based on a plurality of performance levels, a first routing provider from the plurality of routing providers to transmit a first message of a user to a client device of a recipient.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the selecting is performed at a message routing system that is coupled to each of the plurality of routing providers via a network.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the message routing system maintains a separate message queue of a plurality of message queues for each of the plurality of routing providers.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the selecting is based on a subset of the plurality of performance levels calculated using a sliding window of a rate at which messages are dequeued from each message queue.

13. The system of claim 10, the operations further comprising: adding, at the message routing system, the first message into a first message queue designated to the first routing provider.

14. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: receiving, by the message routing system and from the first routing provider, a dequeue request indicating that the first routing provider has available bandwidth exceeding a predefined threshold, to process a new message; responsive to the dequeue request, determining, by the message routing system and based on a predefined order, that the first message is to be dequeued from the first message queue designated to the first routing provider; and dequeuing, by the message routing system, the first message from the first message queue to the first routing provider for delivery to the client device of the recipient.

15. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions that, when executed by one or more computer processors of one or more computing devices, cause the one or more computer

processors to perform operations comprising: receiving a plurality of feedback data each associated with one of a plurality of routing providers, each of the plurality of feedback data indicating whether messages allocated to a corresponding routing provider were successfully delivered; determining a conversion rate for each routing provider based on corresponding feedback data; determining a congestion level for each routing provider based on a rate at which messages are dequeued from a message queue of a corresponding routing provider; and determining a performance level of each routing provider based on the corresponding conversion rate and the corresponding congestion level.

16. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 15, the operations further comprising: selecting, based on a plurality of performance levels, a first routing provider from the plurality of routing providers to transmit a first message of a user to a client device of a recipient.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the selecting is performed at a message routing system that is coupled to each of the plurality of routing providers via a network, and wherein the message routing system maintains a separate message queue of a plurality of message queues for each of the plurality of routing providers.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 17, wherein the selecting is based on a subset of the plurality of performance levels calculated using a sliding window of a rate at which messages are dequeued from each message queue.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 17, the operations further comprising: adding, at the message routing system, the first message into a first message queue designated to the first routing provider.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 19, the operations further comprising: receiving, by the message routing system and from the first routing provider, a dequeue request indicating that the first routing provider has available bandwidth exceeding a predefined threshold, to process a new message; responsive to the dequeue request, determining, by the message routing system and based on a predefined order, that the first message is to be dequeued from the first message queue designated to the first routing provider; and dequeuing, by the message routing system, the first message from the first message queue to the first routing provider for delivery to the client device of the recipient.
